

INSTANT REPLAY . . .

By ROGER BRANDT
Daily World Sports Editor



Guest Column . . .

By PAUL MANASSEH
LSU Sports Information Director

Sports is fun.

Or is that ungrammatical?

Tennyrate, after spending some one-third of a century in athletics, both professional and amateur, I'm convinced that the old adage "you meet such interesting people in the newspaper business . . . and they're all in the newspaper business" isn't quite true.

I think the most interesting, the most fascinating people travel through the sports pages.



PAUL MANASSEH

other somebody-or-other and takes several years to establish himself as an individual coach with superb talents.

There are a few disturbing elements too.

A Denny McLain is slapped on the wrist when a much more severe penalty is indicated; a Brian Piccolo dies before his time, felled by the dread disease, cancer; a Dave Hill voices his opinion and is fined \$150 for daring to; a \$90,000 a year ball player threatens to upset the status quo of America's erstwhile national pastime and businessmen posing as sportsmen raise ugly threats of what it will do to baseball.

But taken in the whole, sports produces more laughs than all the comics who perform along the Las Vegas strip.

I once was associated with a great football player named Carlton Chester (Cookie) Gilchrist whose escapades and militancy (before that word meant what it means today) kept him in hot water. A sports writer once asked one of Cookie's coaches if the fullback could be described as a "Jekyll and Hyde?" The coach thought a moment and replied: "Absolutely not, one of those guys was a good guy."

Mark Freeman was a former LSU baseball and basketball
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A Joe Namath captures the imagination of a nation through his exploits on the gridiron, then astounds the public with his unorthodox behavior off the field; Jim Bouton spends a major league baseball career as just a journeyman ball player, then writes a book which dispels ancient illusions about the infallibility of diamond performers; a Bill Veeck sets attendance records as a major league club owner, attempts new approaches to tried and true practices and is banished from the major league scene only to return to resurrect a dying horse track in a Boston Suburb; a Charlie McClendon is pegged as another